Just before that incident, China and Russia came together. They gave a joint declaration for the Russian Federation and for the promotion of China on its international law principles on June 26, 2016, clearly stating that China and Russia had reiterated their total commitments to the principles mentioned in the Charter of the United Nations. The 1970 Declaration of the United Nations on the principles of International Law, vis-à-vis friendly relations and cooperation among several states, said that ties must be maintained according to the Charter of the United Nations (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of People's Republic of China 2016a). These are also guided by the 'Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence' within International Law, which are the cornerstone for just and equitable international relations, featuring 'win–win' cooperation among states. It creates a community of a shared future for humanity and establishes a shared space of equal security and economic cooperation (ibid.). Another significant development was when Crimean citizens voted in 2014, 95 percent agreed to secede from Ukraine and join Russia. The United States had no option except to impose economic sanctions (Barnett 2014). However, China stood by Russia and promised to sign on a $400 trade deal to shore up the Russian economy, and China did so. It shows how both the countries are helping each other when necessary.

Geopolitical Control

Yevgeny Primakov stated that Russia and China were using a joint power of deterrence to oppose a Western use of force (Ivashov 2014). At the Brazil Fortaleza (2014) summit, the group established the BRICS' New Development Bank and Contingency Reserve Fund (CRF). The well-known fact was that the CRF was saving Russia from its shrinking foreign reserves (ibid.). No country opposed this, including China. On May 21, 2014, Chinese President Xi Jinping remarked that the China–Russia partnership jointly proposed an Asia–Pacific and Security Initiative. At the fourth Summit of the 'Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia,' its theme was a 'New Asian Security Concept for New Progress in Security Cooperation.' This initiative played an essential role in strengthening and maintaining peace and security in the Asia Pacific region, and indeed, China was a staunch supporter of the Asian Security concept. China is working on making this concept materialize soon, and for this to